Company Evidence Index

Product Requirements Document · Cal Hacks 13.0 · October 24, 2026 · Draft v1 for team review

Demo target: Apple · Author: project team · Companion page: files.instinct.com/6hzv0cnj68jh-company-evidence-index-cal-hacks-scope

Status: build scope only. No submission, signup, spend, or contact made.

1. Summary

A persistent, cited record of what a company claims and what the evidence supports, built for investor due diligence. The system ingests public sources about a target company, extracts claims into a ledger, attaches supporting and contradicting evidence with citations, classifies coverage, and keeps snapshots that refresh on a daily cadence. A separate sentiment layer, powered by Signalor mention data, quantifies sampled public sentiment about the target. Demo target: Apple.

2. Problem and audience

An investor researching a company today reads a pitch, skims news, and maybe pulls a filing. Claims made by the company and its employees are scattered across press releases, interviews, posts, and coverage, and checking these claims systematically while tracking changes takes fragmented, repeated research. This product gives an investor a single, cited evidence index on a company that persists and refreshes, so diligence compounds instead of restarting every time.

Primary user: an investor or analyst doing diligence on a company. Secondary: anyone who needs a sourced, current picture of what a company claims and whether the record supports it.

3. Product vision

The full ambition: find everything about the company. Its raises. Every claim made by its public accounts and by its employees, each one proven or disproven with evidence. Every article and post about the company, classified. All available financial data where public; where not public, public posts as signals about the state of the company. All of it indexed, so once the system monitors a company it keeps a snapshot and refreshes it, daily to start.

"Everything" is the aspiration the product grows toward, source by source. No version promises whole-internet coverage, and every screen names what was checked and what was not.

4. Goals and non-goals

Goals for the hackathon demo

- A working claim ledger on one real target (Apple) with citations and claim statuses: supported, contradicted, unresolved.
- A persistent snapshot with a visible refresh diff, proving the index compounds rather than regenerating.

- A coverage panel listing sources checked, unresolved claims, and gaps.
- A sentiment layer from Signalor data, shown with sample size, date range, platforms, and method.

Non-goals

- No claim of whole-internet coverage.
- No personal social-media risk scoring of individuals. The subject is a company and its claims, not judgments about people's posts, friends, or lifestyle.
- No investment recommendation, loan decision, or "suspicious" verdict. The tool cites evidence and shows uncertainty; a reviewer decides.
- No reuse of Signalor code. Cal Hacks requires all implementation during the event; ideas and architecture beforehand are fine.
- No Signalor production changes, exports, or public disclosure of its data. Signalor is used read-only, as a data source.

5. Core requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
R1	Claim ledger: every claim carries source, date, the claim text, evidence for, evidence against, and a status (supported, contradicted, unresolved). Every entry cites its source.	P0
R2	Attribution discipline: articles and posts stay attributed opinions unless independently supported. An employee's statement is logged as a claim by that person, not automatically the company's.	P0
R3	Evidence classes stay separate: verified financials (filings, official disclosures) never blend with estimates or social signals into one score. No public financial data renders as unknown, never as an inference from social posts.	P0
R4	Persistent store keyed by company with fetch timestamps; a snapshot survives between runs.	P0
R5	Refresh with a visible diff: what changed since the last snapshot.	P0
R6	Coverage panel: sources checked, claims unresolved, explicit gaps. Missing evidence is shown as missing, never as proof of fraud.	P0
R7	Article and post classification per source item (topic, stance, reach where available), feeding the ledger but labeled as coverage, not fact.	P1
R8	Daily refresh cadence after the demo, subject to source access and cost.	P1

6. Demo target: Apple

Apple is the demo company. It suits the demo for practical reasons: as a public company its verified financials are complete and free through SEC EDGAR (10-K, 10-Q, 8-K, proxy); its official claims are easy to harvest

(newsroom releases, keynote statements, executive interviews); and its press coverage is heavy, which exercises the classification step. Choosing a large public company also reduces the need to profile individuals.

Fixed, named source set for the demo: EDGAR filings, Google News, apple.com newsroom and keynote claims, a small set of seeded public posts, and Signalor mention data for the sentiment layer.

7. Data sources

Access, cost, and terms checked October 24, 2026 against the sources in section 13.

Source	Role	Access	Cost and terms status
SEC EDGAR	Verified financials backbone for Apple (10-K, 10-Q, 8-K, proxy). Form D covers many private raises for future private targets, but not every raise files, and the form records amounts offered and sold, not a complete funding picture.	**Free**	Free official APIs.
Google News RSS	Article discovery and classification input.	**Free**	Free per-query feeds.
Company site / newsroom	The company's own claims: newsroom, keynote, executive interviews.	**Free**	Direct public fetch.
Signalor	Sampled public sentiment layer (section 8).	**Own data**	Used read-only as an external data source; no code reused; no production changes.
Crunchbase	Private-company raises and firmographics (mostly irrelevant for Apple).	Manual	No free API; sales-gated custom pricing; free web account limited to 5 results per search; license bars redistribution. Demo: manual lookups or skip.
X (Twitter)	Optional public-post signals.	Paid	Pay-per-use with no free tier; developer account and prepaid card required. Current official rates and signup requirements must be verified against the X docs before any use or budget.
LinkedIn / employee posts	Employee claims.	Manual	No general public API covers employee posts for this kind of build. Demo: manually collected, cited evidence the team is authorized to access; not an automated feed.
CRS sandbox	Optional track alignment only.	Test data	Test identities only; test-business coverage and field depth unverified. The idea does not need CRS.

> **Honest coverage line.** The demo must name its source list and its gaps on screen. Judges will find any gap we do not name first.

8. Signalor sentiment layer

Signalor data quantifies sampled public sentiment on the target, on top of the evidence index. It is a separate evidence layer with its own panel, never blended into the financial-risk picture, and never presented as everyone's opinion: it is a labeled sample of collected public posts.

Proposed integration (availability unverified)

> Signalor is a public-mention sentiment product; the hack would use it read-only as an external data source, the way it would use Crunchbase or EDGAR. Aggregate figures would appear only with sample size, date range, platforms covered, and collection method alongside every number. Whether the data can be accessed for the demo, and its freshness, is unverified; the panel degrades gracefully to the other sources if it is unavailable.

Requirements

ID	Requirement	Priority
S1	Sentiment panel shows aggregate sentiment with sample size, date range, platforms covered, and collection method alongside every number.	P0
S2	The layer never feeds the financial-risk picture and is labeled as a sample of collected public posts.	P0
S3	Show sentiment aggregates and metadata, not verbatim posts. Whether source platform terms allow showing collected post content in a demo is unverified.	P0
S4	Graceful degradation: if current Apple coverage is thin or stale, the panel says so and shows what exists rather than implying coverage.	P0

Dependency, unresolved.

Whether Signalor mention data is available to the demo (access route, freshness, platform mix) is unverified. The fresh-built pipeline stands on its other sources either way.

> **Eligibility caveat, not a blocker.** The published rules restrict pre-existing code, not data, and do not expressly cover pre-existing data sources. Treating Signalor data as allowed, the way Crunchbase or EDGAR would be, is a planning assumption, not confirmed permission. If a judge rules otherwise, the fresh-built pipeline still stands on its other sources.

9. Demo script

1. Open on Apple: fixed, named source set visible (EDGAR, Google News, apple.com newsroom and keynote claims, seeded posts, Signalor mentions).
2. Show ingestion into the persistent store with fetch timestamps: the snapshot.
3. Show the claim ledger: claims with citations, evidence for and against, statuses.
4. Aim for one consequential contradiction with its evidence chain as the demo moment, for example a claimed capability or commitment the sources do not support. A target whose claims come back supported or unresolved is an equally valid result; never manufacture a contradiction.
5. Run a refresh and show the diff. This proves persistence.
6. Show the sentiment layer and the coverage panel side by side: sampled sentiment with its provenance, and the honest list of gaps.

10. Rules compliance

- Fresh implementation during the event is required; ideation beforehand is allowed (calhacks.io FAQ). Devpost adds that all work must be done during the hackathon. Published rules require fresh implementation; they do not expressly address pre-existing data sources.
- No Signalor code is copied. The hack builds its own pipeline fresh; Signalor supplies data only.
- Team size conflict: Hive says 1-4, Devpost says 2-4. Unresolved; confirm with the directors if team size matters.

11. Track fit

Track	Fit	Notes
Microsoft	**Strong**	Broadest problem space and the most natural fit for an evidence-gathering agent.
Hyphenate	**Upside**	Autonomous finance systems fits, but you have flagged the field as massively competitive. The project stands on its own; Hyphenate is a bonus, not the reason it exists.
CRS	**Optional**	Only if sandbox business-credit data is genuinely at the core of the demo. Not forced.

No official rule on whether tracks stack or require opt-in. MLH side prizes need opt-in at submission; everything else needs the directors.

12. Open questions and dependencies

Data access: whether Signalor mention data can be used for the demo is unverified (access route, coverage freshness). The sentiment panel shows provenance for whatever it displays.

- **Directors (#0-ask-directors or team@hackberkeley.org):** track stacking and opt-in; whether Signalor architecture as reference material is acceptable.

- **Team:** whether X is worth its access cost (verify official rates first); whether to check CRS sandbox business coverage on site.

13. Sources

- SEC developer resources: https://www.sec.gov/about/developer-resources
- SEC filing search (EDGAR full-text and Form D): https://www.sec.gov/search-filings
- Crunchbase API FAQ: https://support.crunchbase.com/hc/en-us/articles/32319290128019-Crunchbase-API-FAQ
- Crunchbase API docs and license terms: https://data.crunchbase.com/docs/using-the-api
- X API official docs (verify current pricing before use): https://docs.x.com
- CRS hackathon sandbox: https://calhacks.crscreditapi.com
- Cal Hacks FAQ (implementation rule): https://www.calhacks.io/
- Cal Hacks Devpost rules (all work during event): https://cal-hacks-13-0.devpost.com/rules
- Hive prizes and FAQ: https://hive.hackberkeley.org/prizes and https://hive.hackberkeley.org/faq

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Source facts checked October 24, 2026. Whether Signalor data is available to the demo is unverified. This document is a build scope: no submission, signup, spend, external contact, or Signalor change has been made.